



**THE
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FREE PDF GUIDE

PLAY LIKE PAUL MCCARTNEY

5 Signature Moves

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How To Play Like Paul McCartney

Five McCartney-Style Moves to Try



Introduction from Adam

Paul McCartney's piano style is simple, musical, and full of clever detail. Here are a few signature ideas from his live playing to help you bring some of that movement, groove, and colour into your own playing.

Artist profile:

Paul McCartney



Paul McCartney is a legendary singer, songwriter, and pianist whose playing shaped many of the **Beatles'** most iconic songs. His piano style is melodic, rhythmic, and full of subtle detail.

Blending **pop, rock and roll, and ballad** playing, his sound is simple on the surface but always musical and distinctive. His piano parts helped define a huge part of the Beatles' sound.

Watch the Paul McCartney performances that inspired the examples in this guide:

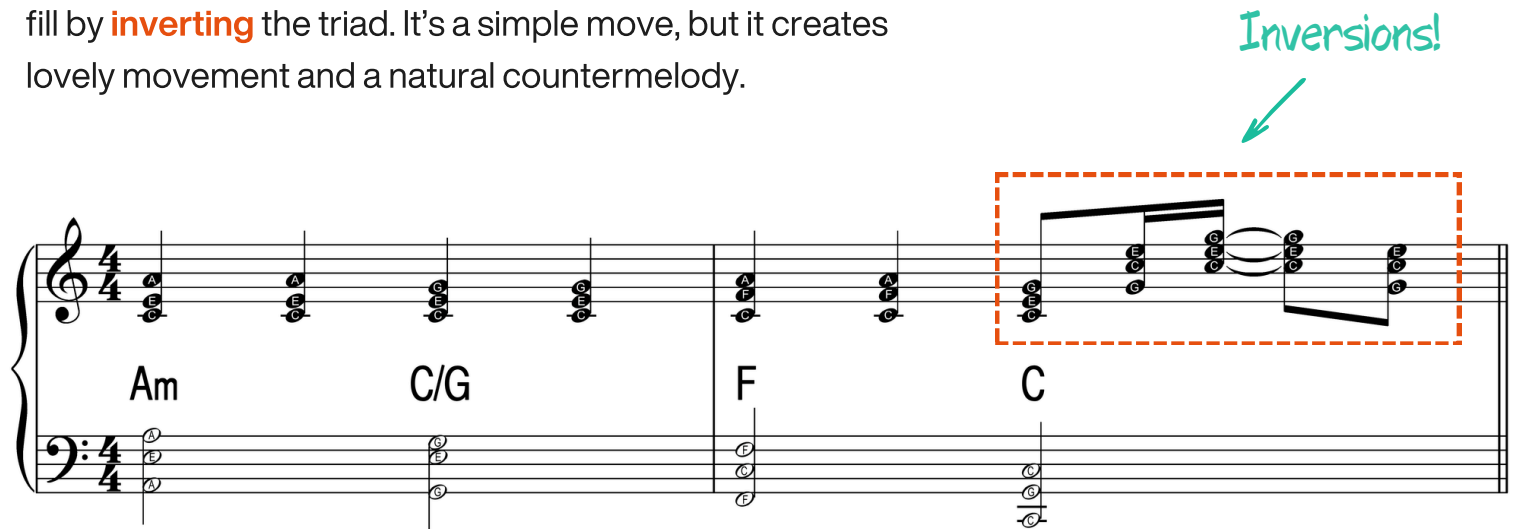
- [Let It Be \(Live\)](#)
- [The Long & Winding Road](#)
- [Lady Madonna](#)

Concept #1

Inverting Triads

On the live version of **Let It Be**, McCartney played this little fill by **inverting** the triad. It's a simple move, but it creates lovely movement and a natural counter melody.

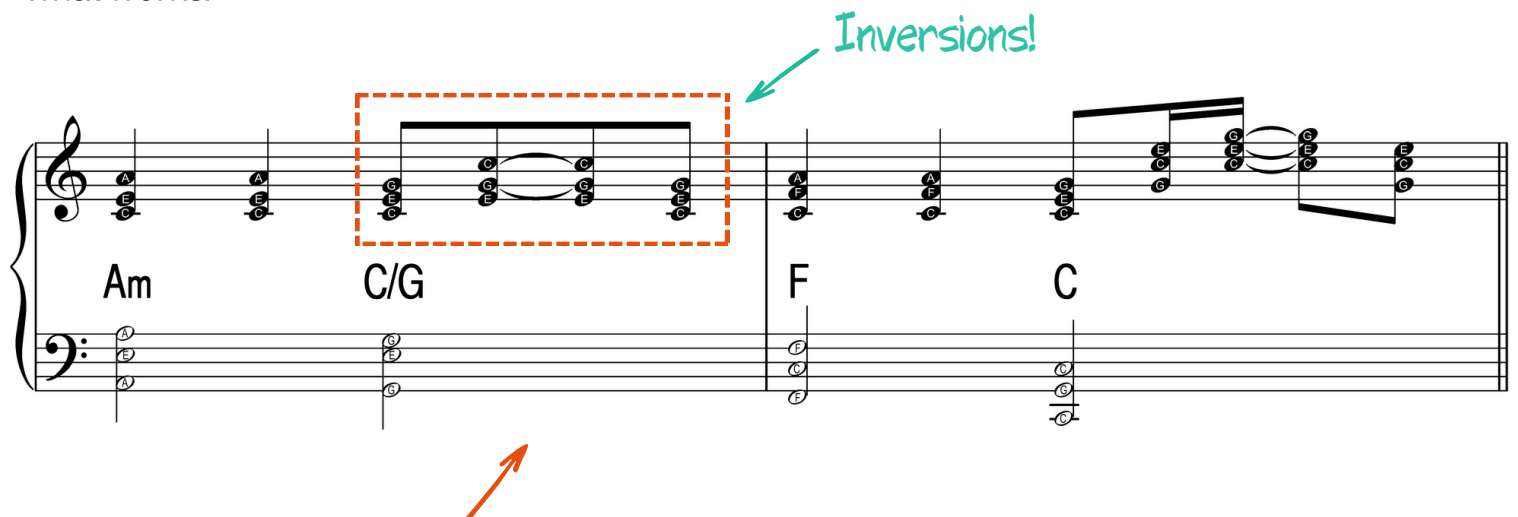
Inversions!



Am C/G F C

You can place inversions **wherever you feel comfortable** to create momentum and decorate the progression. In this example, I've tried it over the C/G — explore different rhythms and see what works!

Inversions!



Am C/G F C



"You'll have even more fun once you start trying your own variations!"

Concept #2

Walkdowns

Walkdowns are a classic part of McCartney and Beatles-style writing, but this one is extra special because it uses the **flat 7**, a chord outside the key. Try using the flat 7 in your own **walkdowns**, or borrow the whole move for a richer ending.

A musical score for a piano, showing a sequence of chords in F major. The chords are: F, C/E, Dm⁷, C, B^b, F/A, G, F, and C. The B^b chord is highlighted with a dashed orange box, and a green arrow points to it with the text "Flat 7!". The notation is in treble and bass clefs, with chord symbols written below the notes.

Concept #3

Doubling the Melody

Playing the melody while singing can be really effective. In *The Long and Winding Road*, McCartney **doubles the vocal line**, then lets the piano answer back.

A musical score for a piano, showing a sequence of chords in C minor. The chords are: C^m and A^b/B^b. The notation is in treble and bass clefs, with chord symbols written below the notes. The first part is labeled "Melody..." and the second part is labeled "Response...".

Concept #4

Being the Bassist

Let your left hand think like a **bass player** and keep the groove rooted. McCartney played those octaves in **Lady Madonna**, and they give the song that classic driving feel.

Octaves!

Concept #5

Inverted Pedal

An **inverted pedal** is when you keep one note at the top of all the chords in your progression.

In the live Lady Madonna outro, McCartney **keeps an A over the changing chords**, which helps connect everything and gives the ending a strong sense of tension and momentum.

Pedal tone!